Design for Public Community of Practice

11.11.26

Agenda &
Speaker Notes

Agenda

09:30	Registration	
10:00	Too Many Cooks Two-hour workshop	Shona Galt
12:30	Design in practice	
	Co-design	Ed Harte
	From Service Design to Delivery	Jackson Nginya
	Resilience	Martin Morgan Tony Young
13:00	Panel Design in practice	Ed Harte Jackson Nginya Martin Morgan Tony Young
13:15	Lunch	
14:00	Building design capability	
	Designing from the Inside Out	Emma Conway
	Learning by Doing	Michelle Devine
	One Year In	Robert Farrelly
14:30	Panel Building design capability	Emma Conway Michelle Devine Robert Farrelly
14:45	Who Designs the Public? Keynote	Bernd Fesel Dr Olaf Kranz
15:25	Questions Moderated by Trevor Vaugh	
15:40	Stronger Together	Trevor Vaugh
16:00	Close	

Speaker notes

10:00
Workshop

Shona Galt
Policy Designer, London Borough of Camden

Too Many Cooks

Too Many Cooks is an interactive service design simulation game that shows how good people, working hard within their own service teams, can still fail to deliver a good outcome for residents. Participants step into different organisational roles and work together to help a fictional resident, Mrs Iris Bennett, secure adaptations to her home after a stroke. Despite everyone's best intentions, progress is often slow because nobody can see the whole service.

About Shona

Shona is a policy designer at the London Borough of Camden, where she works with multi-disciplinary teams to design resident-centred policies and drive system change. Her background is in local government policy and project management, having worked across adult and children's social care services in embedded transformation teams.

In her own time, Shona is also vice chair of the London Boroughs Women's Network, a 600-member community of women working across local government that champions gender equity and shared learning. She was awarded a Local Government Chronicle Award in 2024 for her leadership and impact.

12:30
Design in practice

Ed Harte
Digital for Care Patient Public Partnership Advisory Group Programme Lead, Digital Transformation Office, Technology and Transformation, HSE

Co-design

How do you make co-design work in a large organisation where it is not yet part of everyday practice? Drawing on practical experience, Edward will explore how to secure senior sponsorship, gain formal endorsement and create the conditions for meaningful collaboration. The talk will address common barriers and practical ways to overcome them, sharing tools and tips that move beyond buzzwords and theory to build organisational support, create space for different voices and embed co-design into how work gets done.

About Ed

Edward's background spans enterprise architecture, interoperability, and large-scale digital programmes, with particular expertise in stakeholder management, Co-Design and critical problem solving. Alongside his technical experience, he has held roles in strategic communications and stakeholder engagement.

He currently works in the HSE's Digital Transformation Office, where he is leading the development of the Digital for Care Patient Public Partnership Advisory Group, an initiative designed to embed patient and public voices at the heart of digital health design and decision-making. He is

currently undertaking a PhD in Design Innovation, with a research focus on barriers to digital healthcare within the Irish public health system. Edward is passionate about co-design, equity of voice, and building practical frameworks that enable organisations to work effectively with patients, staff, and partners to deliver patient-led, technology-enabled care.

Design in practice

Jackson Nginya
Assistant Principal Officer and Service Design Lead, Department of Justice, Home Affairs and Migration

From Service Design to Delivery

Closing the Access and Trust Gap by Designing for and with Immigration Services Applicants' Representatives

"The glass cannot be full, until it is 100% full. Likewise, a service cannot be accessible until everyone can access it." Jackson will share how Government Departments can deliver innovative public services and drive equitable outcomes by intentionally designing for the remaining users facing access barriers, rather than assuming one solution fits all. He will show how a user-focused design approach and development is closing the gap for immigration services applicants who may struggle with existing self-service digital solutions due to accessibility, financial, awareness or digital literacy challenges. He believes the greatest opportunities for improving public outcomes lie in not only optimising for the 90% of population who are already served, but in learning from and designing for the 10% who aren't through user research, empathy and customer insight.

About Jackson

Jackson holds an MBA and certifications in Design Thinking and Project Management. A former management consultant, he moved from advising to delivering change by joining public service, driven by a belief in technology and design as forces for good. Having worked across five countries in two continents, he is passionate about improving societal wellbeing and now leads the design of user-centred services using customer insights. He combines empathy, curiosity and continuous learning with his own experiences as a user or member of the public to ensure public services are designed around the real needs and aspirations of the people who use (and deliver) them.

Working at the intersection of policy, operations and innovation, Jackson drives service improvement through strategic leadership, creative problem-solving and delivery. He champions service design as a mindset and practice for public service reform, helping teams better understand user needs, redesign service journeys and improve customer experiences. Through his work on policy, digital transformation and capability building, he is helping embed trust in government services and enabling teams to design services for users, with users.

Design in practice

Martin Morgan
Service Designer, Land & Property Services, Department of Finance (NI)

Tony Young
Service Designer, Land & Property Services, Department of Finance (NI)

Resilience

About Martin

Martin is a Service Designer at Land & Property Services within the Department of Finance and has been working in the Northern Ireland Civil Service for 26 years. He has worked in the NI Public Sector Innovation Lab and across the Department for Communities on complex transformation projects including Child Support and Universal Credit. He has also worked on numerous user research and design projects including the Ukrainian Refugee Assistance Centres and the new Redundancy Payments Service.

About Tony

Tony is a Service Designer at Land & Property Services within the Department of Finance, and has been working in the Northern Ireland Civil Service for almost 39 years. He worked across a few NI Departments before joining the NI Public Sector Innovation Lab. Tony's service design work spans a wide range of areas including Probate, Advance Care Planning, Childcare, the Ukrainian Refugee Assistance Centres and the new Redundancy Payment Service.

13:00
Panel

Design in practice

Questions and discussion with Ed Harte, Jackson Nginya, Martin Morgan and Tony Young, facilitated by Trevor Vaugh.

14:00
Building design capability

Emma Conway
Senior Graphic Designer, Communications & Development Office, National Library of Ireland

Designing from the Inside Out

Emma will discuss her transition from the private sector to an in-house design role at the National Library of Ireland, and how this experience has shifted her perspective on what it means to be a designer. She will explore the benefits of being embedded within an organisation, from gaining a deeper understanding of its people and challenges to recognising where design can add value, even when it hasn't been asked for. Drawing on her experience across both sectors, Emma will reflect on the value of involving designers throughout a project's development, not just as visual communicators, but as creative thinkers, problem-solvers and collaborators. She will also consider the potential for more design roles within public institutions and the positive impact they could have.

About Emma

Emma is a graphic designer with over 15 years' experience working across agencies in Dublin and Rotterdam, including Image Now, Dept and Language. She is currently the first in-house graphic designer at the National Library of Ireland, having previously worked on projects for clients including Temple Bar Gallery, the Yes Campaign and Trinity College Dublin.

Emma is passionate about the role design plays in shaping our cities, from improving public spaces and everyday experiences to contributing to their cultural identity. Alongside her work designing for Dublin's arts and cultural

scene, she advocates for more design roles within the public sector, believing designers can help create more accessible, engaging and enjoyable cities and towns.

Building design capability

Michelle Devine
Innovation Lead, Kildare County Council

Learning by Doing

Our Design Journey So Far

Many public organisations recognise the value of design, but few start with a dedicated design team. This talk shares Kildare County Council's experience of introducing design within a local authority and what happened when colleagues were given the opportunity to apply design to real organisational challenges. From building initial awareness and organisational support, to delivering a design programme grounded in learning by doing, the session reflects on what we have learned so far, the value design can bring to public services, and how we are exploring the next stage of our journey.

About Michelle

Michelle Devine is Innovation Lead with Kildare County Council, one of Ireland's 31 local authorities, who deliver 1,000-plus services to their citizens. Michelle works with colleagues across the organisation to support new and better ways of working, drawing on approaches including design, lean, digital and AI. Her work includes exploring how design can support Kildare's wider innovation ambition to improve services and processes that deliver better outcomes for staff, citizens and stakeholders.

Building design capability

Robert Farrelly
Administrative Officer, Central Design Team, DPER

One Year In

Robert looks back on his first year in the public service after leaving private practice: what changed in moving from studio work to working inside a government department, what carried over, and what he has learned about where design fits in the day-to-day work of the public service.

About Robert

Robert is a designer in the Central Design Team at DPER, where he works on the Life Events Programme and the Design for Public Value Guidelines, and helps build the design community of practice across the public service.

Before joining the public service he spent nearly two decades in practice, co-founding the design studios Post Studio and Estd and advising organisations on design and strategy. He is a visiting lecturer at NCAD, holds an adjunct position at the UCD School of Education and is completing an MA in Service Design at NCAD.

14:30
Panel

Building design capability

Questions and discussion with Emma Conway, Michelle Devine and Robert Farrelly, facilitated by Trevor Vaugh.

14:45
Keynote

Bernd Fesel
Festival Director, Creative Bureaucracy Festival, Falling Walls Foundation

Dr Olaf Kranz
Head of Kreativ München, City of Munich

Who Designs the Public?

Creative Practice and Public Service Transformation

Followed by questions from the audience at 15:25, moderated by Trevor Vaugh.

About Bernd

Bernd Fesel is Festival Director of the Creative Bureaucracy Festival in Berlin, organised by the Falling Walls Foundation. The festival brings together more than 2,000 participants from public administration, politics and the non-profit sector each year to discuss innovation in the public sector and celebrate administrative talent from around the world. It was initiated in 2018 by Charles Landry, author of The Creative Bureaucracy, and Sebastian Turner.

Fesel brings two decades of experience in building the European creative economy. In 2004 he founded the German Annual Conference of the Creative Industries in Berlin, followed by the European Creative Industries Summit. From 2007 to 2018 he worked in the Ruhr region, first as Deputy Director of the European Capital of Culture RUHR.2010 and then as Senior Advisor at the European Centre for Creative Economy in Dortmund. In 2011 he initiated the European Creative Business Network, today Creative FED, which he later directed. Most recently he was founding CEO of EIT Culture & Creativity. He studied economics and philosophy in Heidelberg and Bonn.

About Kranz

Dr Olaf Kranz heads Kreativ München, the City of Munich's team for the cultural and creative industries. The team sits within the city administration. It was established by city council mandate in 2014 to shape favourable local conditions for freelancers and companies across all eleven creative industry sub-sectors. It offers free business advice, training and networking, raises the sector's visibility, strengthens its international presence and helps creatives find affordable workspace. Munich is Germany's leading creative industries hub and ranks second in Europe, behind Paris and ahead of London.

A sociologist by training, Kranz founded a fashion label in Berlin in 2014 with his wife, a fashion designer. He later brought fashion, design and the creative industries into his teaching and research at the University of Regensburg. From 2019 to 2022 he worked on an EU research project on two linked questions: what conditions allow creative industries to thrive in medium-sized cities, and how these industries drive culture-led urban development.

15:40
Close

Trevor Vaugh
DPER

Stronger Together

An open discussion on where the community goes next, drawing on the day, followed by the close.